

# Delaware County Commissioners Meeting February 6th 2023

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a717F4YhZXE">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a717F4YhZXE</a> |
| Publication Date | 2023-02-06T16:46:09Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

**Meeting Date:** February 6, 2023

**Report Type:** Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

### 1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioner meeting to order at **00:00:06** on February 6, 2023. Notice was given that live streaming faced connectivity issues due to a bad connection. A moment of silence was held following the Pledge of Allegiance to honor Marta Moody, the late Director of the Planning Commission and a valued member of the county family who passed away recently.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Mr. King, Ms. Reagan, Mr. Brooks, Mr. Henry (Presiding officer/Board members).
  - **Absent:** Not explicitly noted.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Henry / Board leadership.

## 2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

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- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opened with the Pledge of Allegiance and a moment of silence for Marta Moody 00:00:22.
  - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:02:50 Approval of the January 17, 2023 Commissioners meeting minutes.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
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## 3. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:01:50 Appointment: County Commissioner Executive Assistant / Office Manager**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Following interviews of several candidates, the board moved to appoint Sarah Hodges to the position of executive assistant / office manager, with an anticipated start date of February 15th.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:02:31 Appointment: East Central Indiana Regional Planning District**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Appointment of James King and Jessica Piper to the East Central Indiana Regional Planning District.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:03:10 Presentation & Funding Request: Guardian Advocates Incorporated**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Linda Johnson, Development Coordinator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Linda Johnson provided an update on Guardian Advocates (serving Madison, Delaware, and Grant counties), an Indiana Supreme Court-approved probate code program assisting incapacitated adults/seniors without appropriate family. Delaware County's guardianship cases grew from 9 last fall to 15. The organization requested a 2023 contribution of \$10,000. Commissioners expressed willingness to support the request but elected to wait until the new office manager is onboarded and funding can be reviewed.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled/Deferred for further review mid-year (June).
- **00:08:56 Presentation: Schaefer Leadership Academy & Ball State University Community Engagement**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mitch Isaacs, Executive Director of Schaefer Leadership Academy, and Heather Williams, Office of Community Engagement at Ball State University.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the upcoming 8th annual Neighborhood Idea Conference (themed "Aces and Eights") and invited county residents to participate. Additionally, Heather Williams discussed the success of organizing Muncie city neighborhoods (growing active neighborhood associations from 5 to 32 since 2014)

and proposed conducting a similar assessment/SWOT analysis to help county neighborhoods organize. Commissioners expressed support and requested a formal proposal.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; proposal requested for the next meeting.
- **00:14:09 Bid Opening: Highway Department Material Bids**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (Highway Department / Staff).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Opened material bids for paving projects, stone, asphalt mixes, emulsions, and fuel from vendors including AG Best (fuel), IMI (stone and various asphalt mixes), Asphalt Materials Inc. (asphalt emulsions), and ENB Paving (surface asphalt, intermediate base, cold mix).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to take under advisement; Angie Moyer to tabulate pricing for a future vote.
- **00:19:35 Bid Opening: 2023 Road Paving Projects (Community Crossings Grant)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (Highway Department / Staff).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Opened two bids for Community Crossings grant road paving projects across five locations (Walnut St., Black Cemetery Rd., CR 550, CR 800 W, and Proctor Rd.):
    1. *Brooks Construction:* Total bid of \$1,461,727.00.
    2. *ENB Paving:* Total bid of \$1,495,092.67.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to take under advisement.
- **00:23:36 Subdivision Plat Dedication: Prairie Creek Woods**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Vannice, Ashton Land Surveyor.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented right-of-way dedications for 400 East (west side) and Burlington Drive (east side) associated with a property at 6101 South Burlington Drive, having already passed the planning procedure process. (An additional minor subdivision plat for Howell Place on County Road 700 West was noted for submission at the next meeting due to administrative transition delays).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted / Approved Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:26:53 Grant Agreement: Department of Health COVID-19 / School Health Grant**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented on behalf of Mr. Bain (Health Department).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** A grant agreement providing \$440,000 this year and \$440,000 next year in cooperative funding between the health department and local school corporations for student healthcare initiatives.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:28:18 Memorandum of Understanding (MOU): Yorktown Community Schools & Health Department**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented on behalf of Mr. Bain.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** An MOU focused on mental health and suicide prevention, under which Yorktown Community Schools will host a mandatory speaker/seminar for all teachers and staff.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:29:04 Board of Zoning Appeals (BZA) Variance & Rail Spur Lease**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout, Delaware County Economic Development.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Brad Bookout requested approval to proceed with variance documents, proposed agreements, and railcar leases relating to the rail spur. County attorneys reviewed and incorporated changes.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:29:53 Grant Application: Five Tool Academy (Tourism Commission Grant)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of a Tourism Commission visitor bureau grant recommendation for Five Tool Academy (a growing tournament management company and baseball/softball training facility located at 9000 West Smith Street in Yorktown) in the amount of \$45,575.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:32:59 Department Head Request: 911 / EMA Center Renovations**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 / EMA Center Director.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested funding not to exceed \$70,000 from ARPA funds to renovate bathrooms, install a shower, replace a hot water heater, and install a stove and exhaust fan in the kitchen at the 911/EMA Center building. Three quotes will be pursued. (Note: Board discussed pending Treasury updates regarding expanded ARPA uses).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote (Not to exceed \$70,000).
- **00:34:55 Board Discussion / Action: Solar Ordinance Moratorium Extension**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners / John.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Due to the recent passing of Planning Director Marta Moody who had been leading the solar ordinance committee the Planning Commission requires additional time to review her notes and computer files. The current solar moratorium is scheduled to expire on February 28, 2023. The board discussed extending the moratorium for six months (to August) to allow the Planning Commission to complete the amended ordinance.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to draft the ordinance amendment for the next meeting.
- **00:37:03 Contract Approval: Rail Spur Lease Agreement**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John / Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Approval to enter into a lease agreement with a live prospect to place rail cars on the county rail spur at a rate of approximately \$4 per car per day to generate revenue.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
- **00:38:06 Contract Approval: Nighheart Services Agreement for Auditor's Office**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed (Auditor's Office) / John.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal of professional services agreements with Nighheart for the auditor's office (\$6,900 for the current year; \$3,200 for the following year, totaling under \$10,000).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
  - **00:39:15 Payment of Claims**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of claims totaling \$2,419,818.51 and \$156,185.96.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
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#### 4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **00:39:50 Dr. Lin Woody**
    - **Topics Addressed:** Addressed the board regarding a new state opioid matching funds grant program (\$25 million statewide) with a strict application deadline of February 28, 2023. Highlighted that the state heavily emphasizes regional collaboration and cross-board coordination (such as treatment facilities, transitional housing, and the 24/7 crisis drop-off center). Noted an upcoming stakeholder meeting scheduled for Wednesday evening via Zoom to coordinate applications and coordinate with grant writer Dane Minnick (ACDC/Cersei). Commissioners expressed historical caution regarding overly complex multi-agency grant applications that dilute local funding returns compared to sustainable standalone projects.
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#### 5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Upcoming stakeholder Zoom meeting regarding opioid grant funding on Wednesday evening.
  - **Adjournment:** [00:44:19 / 00:54:19] Motion and second to recess/adjourn. Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
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